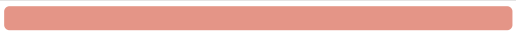
Competitor watch · Q3 2026

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

Peer comparison

Company	Report	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin	Change	Margin measure
Aalberts	**Q3 2026 trading update**	**823.3 EUR**	**+6.6%**	**+13.0%**	**13.8%**	**+130 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	Q3 2026 trading update	–	+3.0%	+2.0%	–		Adj. operating margin
Belimo	no report for this period						
Xylem	Q3 2026 results	2,201 USD	−3.0%	0.0%	23.9%	+70 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	Q3 2026 results	4,695 USD	+12.7%	+7.0%	19.6%	+70 bps	Organic operating margin
Watts	Q3 2026 results — due 4 Nov 2026						
Emerson*	Q3 2026 results (quarter ended 30 Jun 2026)	4,873 USD	+7.0%	+6.0%	28.5%	+140 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	Q3 2026 results	976.0 USD	−4.5%	−5.0%	24.8%	−90 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report for this period						

Reported margin comparison

Aalberts		**13.8%** +130 bps EBITA margin
IMI	no margin disclosed	
Belimo	no report	
Xylem		**23.9%** +70 bps Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab		**19.6%** +70 bps Organic operating margin
Watts	not published yet	
Emerson*		**28.5%** +140 bps Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair		**24.8%** −90 bps Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report	

Each company's own margin measure; levels are not like-for-like.

Company detail

Aalberts · Q3 2026 trading update

Revenue **823.3** EUR m (+6.6% reported) · Organic growth **+13.0%** · EBITA margin **13.8%** +130 bps

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Building	387.2	−0.6%	+9.3%	12.1% (10.8%)	Mixed by region and product line. North America strong, especially valves, with a growing data-centre order book; Europe mixed, residential low, connection systems still under margin pressure.
Industry	238.3	−15.0%	+8.6%	19.1% (17.7%)	Growth supported by business development and geographical expansion; strong demand in aerospace, power generation and defence, stable automotive.
Semicon	201.2	+86.6%	+34.1%	15.5% (13.2%)	Growth accelerated and was higher than expected; capacity ramped up in Europe and Southeast Asia.

Segment growth: All three segments improved organic growth and EBITA margin. Semicon +34.1% organic (revenue nearly doubled, EBITA 31.2 vs 14.2, margin 15.5%) on accelerating AI-related demand. Building +9.3% organic and margin 12.1% (+130 bps), but revenue −2.2m after divestments. Industry +8.6% organic, margin 19.1% (+140 bps); revenue −42.0m from divestments.

Outlook: Entering Q4 with positive momentum and a healthy order book; confident of a full year with improved organic growth and EBITA margin versus 2025.

Source: Q3 2026 press release (PDF, 22 Oct 2026) · Press release (web)

IMI · Q3 2026 trading update

Revenue not reported in this update · Organic growth **+2.0%** · Process Automation orders **+19%** (organic in Q3; +14% YTD (excl. Truflo Marine))

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Automation	–	–	−3.0%		Year to date +2%
Process Automation	–	–	−6.0%		Shipment timing; YTD +1%. Orders +19% in Q3; YTD new construction +27%, aftermarket +7%
Industrial Automation	–	–	+2.0%		YTD +4%
Life Technology	–	–	+11.0%		Year to date +7%
Climate Control	–	–	+13.0%		YTD +7%; data-centre orders £25m YTD (£9m)
Life Science & Fluid Control	–	–	+2.0%		YTD +4%
Transport	–	–	+19.0%		YTD +10%; FY now high-single-digit; strategic review ongoing

Segment growth: Life Technology +11% organic, with Transport +19% (truck market recovery) and Climate Control +13% (data-centre shipments). Automation −3%: Process Automation −6% on shipment timing against +26% last year, while its orders rose 19%. Group +2% against a +12% comparator; +4% year to date.

Outlook: FY 2026 adj. basic EPS raised to 137p–143p (136p–142p), mainly Truflo Marine's extra contribution before its Q4 disposal and stronger Transport. 2027: net interest ~£23m, ~231m shares.

Source: Q3 2026 trading update (PDF) · Q3 2026 trading update (web)

Xylem · Q3 2026 results

Revenue **2,201** USD m (−3.0% reported) · Organic growth **0.0%** · Adj. EBITDA margin **23.9%** +70 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.42** (+4% vs $1.37; excl. $0.11 tariff-refund benefit) · Adj. free cash flow, year to date **444** (462 a year earlier) · Orders **2,331** (+10% organic; +7% reported)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Water Infrastructure	645.0	−1.7%	−1.0%	26.2% (24.4%)	Orders 675 (-1% organic); Treatment softness offset by Transport
Applied Water	489.0	+7.2%	+9.0%	21.3% (21.7%)	Orders 502 (+15% organic); NA data centres and commercial; Americas revenue growth
Measurement & Control Solutions	436.0	−16.5%	−5.0%	24.5% (21.8%)	Orders 504 (+30% organic); Electric metering and analytics down; international metrology divested May 2026
Water Solutions & Services	631.0	−0.5%	−2.0%	24.9% (26.3%)	Orders 650 (+6% organic); Prior-year one-off services and capital work did not repeat

Segment growth: Orders +10% organic (MCS +30% on water and gas meters, AW +15% on NA data centres) but revenue flat: MCS −5% (electric metering, affordability), WSS −2%, WI −1%; AW +9%. Margins up in MCS (+270 bps) and WI (+180 bps), down in AW (−40) and WSS (−140).

Outlook: FY 2026 cut: revenue ~USD 8.95bn (−1%), organic flat, adj. EBITDA margin ~23.2% (+100 bps), adj. EPS $5.40–5.45 ($5.55–5.70), FCF margin ~10.2%. Q4: revenue ~USD 2.3bn, margin ~24.5%.

Source: Q3 2026 earnings package (PDF) · Q3 2026 earnings release

Ecolab · Q3 2026 results

Revenue **4,695** USD m (+12.7% reported) · Organic growth **+7.0%** · Organic operating margin **19.6%** +70 bps · Adj. EPS **$2.18** (+5%; GAAP $1.95; ~10 pts CoolIT drag)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Global Water	2,480	+20.3%	+9.0%	18.0% (17.4%)	
Food & Beverage	–	–	+8.0%		
Heavy Water	–	–	+4.0%		
High-Tech	–	–	+63.0%		+293% at fixed currency incl. acquisitions
Light Water	–	–	+5.0%		
Paper	–	–	+6.0%		
Global Institutional & Specialty	1,638	+2.7%	+3.0%	24.7% (23.6%)	
Institutional	–	–	+2.0%		
Specialty	–	–	+5.0%		
Global Pest Elimination	363.5	+9.3%	+8.0%	20.3% (20.9%)	
Global Life Sciences	215.8	+16.5%	+17.0%	23.3% (18.3%)	

Segment growth: Organic growth accelerated to 7%: High-Tech +63% organic (+293% with Ovivo and CoolIT), Life Sciences +17%, Pest +8%, Water +9%; Institutional & Specialty +3%. Life Sciences OI +49% (margin 23.3%); Water OI +24% at fixed rates.

Outlook: 2026 adj. EPS $8.10–8.20 (+8% to 9%); Q4 $2.13–2.23 with reported sales +12% to 14%; 20% adj. OI margin in 2027.

Source: Q3 2026 earnings presentation (PDF)

Emerson* · Q3 2026 results (quarter ended 30 Jun 2026)

Revenue **4,873** USD m (+7.0% reported) · Underlying growth **+6.0%** · Adj. segment EBITA margin **28.5%** +140 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.71** (+13% vs $1.52) · Free cash flow **1,323** (+36%; margin 27.1%) · Underlying orders **+7%**

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Software & Systems	1,644	+11.1%	+11.0%	31.8% (32.1%)	
Control Systems & Software	1,199	+7.1%	+7.0%		Strong demand in power (Ovation)
Test & Measurement	445.0	+23.6%	+23.0%		Semiconductor, aerospace & defence
Intelligent Devices	2,677	+5.6%	+5.0%	27.9% (25.5%)	
Sensors	1,091	+7.7%	+7.0%		Power and LNG in the Americas
Final Control	1,586	+4.2%	+3.0%		AMEA and Americas, power
Safety & Productivity	552.0	+2.6%	+2.0%	21.2% (20.4%)	
REGIONS					
Americas	2,537	+8.4%	+8.0%		US +10%
Asia, Middle East & Africa	1,475	+8.8%	+8.0%		China −3%
Europe	861.0	+0.6%	−1.0%		

Segment growth: Underlying +6%: Software & Systems +11% (Test & Measurement +23%), Intelligent Devices +5% with margin +240 bps to 27.9%, Safety & Productivity +2%. Americas and AMEA +8%, Europe −1%. Adj. EBITA includes no IEEPA refund (USD 82m excluded).

Outlook: FY 2026 raised: net sales ~+5%, underlying ~+3.5%, adj. EPS ~$6.55, FCF ~USD 3.6bn, adj. segment EBITA margin ~28%.

Source: Q3 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Pentair · Q3 2026 results

Revenue **976.0** USD m (−4.5% reported) · Core sales growth **−5.0%** · Adj. return on sales **24.8%** −90 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.18** (−5%, above $1.05–1.08 guidance; GAAP $0.91) · Free cash flow **153** (179 in Q3 2025)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Flow	262.0	+4.0%	+1.0%	26.2% (23.7%)	
Water Solutions	422.0	+1.0%	–	28.7% (25.0%)	Includes ~USD 6m of tariff refunds
Pool	291.0	−18.0%	−18.0%	24.6% (32.8%)	Channel destock now completed

Segment growth: Flow (+4%, core +1%) and Water Solutions (+1%) both lifted segment income ~15% with return on sales up 250 and 370 bps. Pool −18% with income −38% as the channel destock ended; management targets ~30% Pool return on sales in 2027.

Outlook: FY 2026: sales ~−3%, adj. operating income ~−6%, adj. EPS ~$4.70 (−4%); Q4: sales +7–9% incl. Taco, adj. EPS ~$1.15; FCF >100% of net income.

Source: Q3 2026 earnings presentation (PDF)

Other key competitors (relevance to HFC 1–5)

Caleffi · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Caleffi family) · revenue ~EUR 273m (2025, Caleffi S.p.A. accounts) · FTEs ~1,600; 13 plants in Italy (company)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** INTERCLIMA 2026 (Paris, 28 Sep – 1 Oct): exhibited co-branded with its long-standing French distribution partner Thermador. [Caleffi event page]

Danfoss · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Danfoss family / Bitten & Mads Clausen Foundation) · revenue EUR 9.43bn (2025) · FTEs ~39,300 (H1 2026 report)

- **M&A:** Signed the definitive agreement to acquire Alfagomma (10 Jul 2026): ~EUR 600m sales, ~4,500 employees, 28 production and assembly sites; bought out of a court-supervised liquidation, terms undisclosed. Joins the Fluid Conveyance division of Power Solutions; Australian competition clearance (ACCC) filed 9 Sep, approved 9 Oct; closing expected Q4 2026. Not heating-related, but shows Danfoss's appetite for large deals. [Danfoss release · Modern Distribution Management · ACCC register]

Reflex Winkelmann (reflexGroup) · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Winkelmann Group, family-owned) · revenue n/d (not published) · FTEs >2,100 (company)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Reported 15 Jul 2026: Rimavská Sobota is reflexGroup's eighth production site, adding capacity for domestic hot water and buffer tanks; designed for ~450 employees. Per a third-party event database (unconfirmed): ~300,000 units a year, ~EUR 128m investment. [reflexGroup news · Metroplan project page]

Bell & Gossett (Xylem) · relevance 4/5 (high)

Xylem (NYSE: XYL), Applied Water segment · revenue Applied Water segment USD 1,849m (2025) · FTEs n/d (part of Xylem)

- **Performance:** Applied Water Q3 2026: revenue USD 489m (+9% organic), orders +15% on North American data centres and commercial buildings; adj. EBITDA margin 21.3% (21.7%). [Xylem Q3 2026 earnings package (PDF)]
- **M&A:** Xylem plans to divest AW International (Europe, MEA, APAC) and Specialty Flow Control; AW Americas (Bell & Gossett) joins the new Flow Solutions segment from 1 Jan 2027. [Xylem Q3 2026 earnings package (PDF)]

Grundfos · relevance 4/5 (high)

Private (Poul Due Jensen Foundation) · revenue DKK 34.7bn / ~EUR 4.7bn (2025) · FTEs 21,433 (end-2025)

- **M&A:** Completed the acquisition of EUWA (Gärtringen, Germany; water treatment for breweries and soft drinks, installations in >110 countries), announced mid-July 2026; extends its water-treatment platform after Newterra. [Grundfos release · Brauwelt]
- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** WEFTEC 2026 (New Orleans, 26–30 Sep): unveiled a combined water-treatment offer bringing Newterra, MECO and Water Works under the Grundfos brand together with its own pumps. [iGrow News]

Taco Comfort Solutions · relevance 4/5 (high)

Pentair (NYSE: PNR) since 1 Oct 2026; previously family-owned · revenue ~USD 560m (2026e, Pentair) · FTEs n/d (estimates 350–1,000)

- **Performance:** Taco expected 2026 sales of ~USD 560m (growth >10%), above Pentair's previous expectation; Pentair expects EPS accretion in 2027. [Pentair Q3 2026 presentation (PDF)]
- **M&A:** Pentair agreed (28 Jul 2026) to acquire Taco Group Holdings for ~USD 1.4bn; closed 1 Oct 2026. Pentair cites hydronic and data-centre HVAC exposure (schools, hospitals, commercial buildings). [Taco press release · Pentair Q3 2026 presentation (PDF)]
- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Lubbock, Texas site earned two industry certifications (Aug 2026); new owner committed to keeping a major presence in Cranston. [RI News Today]

Armstrong Fluid Technology · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Private (Armstrong family) · revenue n/d · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Showcased HVAC and intelligent fluid-flow solutions at BEX Asia, Singapore (Sep 2026). [Trade Arabia]

Siemens Smart Infrastructure* · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Listed (Siemens AG), segment · revenue ~EUR 23bn run-rate (FY 2026 quarters) · FTEs n/d

- **Performance:** Fiscal Q3 2026: orders EUR 8.0bn (+42%, record), revenue EUR 6.4bn (+13% comparable), profit EUR 1.3bn (20.0%); backlog EUR 23.7bn; FY 2026 outlook raised to +10–11% revenue, 18.5–19.5% margin. [Siemens Q3 FY2026 release (PDF)]

Wilo · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Private (Wilo-Foundation) · revenue EUR 1,918.7m (2025) · FTEs ~9,000 (2025)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Established Wilo Japan (Aug 2026), targeting data centres. [MONOist]

Alfa Laval · relevance 2/5 (low)

Listed (Nasdaq Stockholm: ALFA) · revenue SEK 52.6bn (9M 2026) · FTEs n/d

- **Performance:** Q3 2026: record order intake SEK 23.2bn (+33% organic), net sales SEK 18.6bn (~+6% organic), adj. EBITA margin 18.1% (18.4%); data-centre orders ~SEK 2bn in the quarter. [Alfa Laval Q3 2026 report · Investing.com]

Resideo (Honeywell Home) · relevance 2/5 (low)

Listed (NYSE: REZI) · revenue USD 7.5bn (2025, incl. ADI) · FTEs ~14,600 (data aggregator)

- **M&A:** Completed the separation of ADI (distribution) on 3 Aug 2026; standalone Q3 guide USD 705–730m revenue; Q3 results due 10 Nov 2026. [MarketBeat]

Victaulic · relevance 2/5 (low)

Private · revenue ~USD 5.1bn (2026, IBISWorld estimate) · FTEs n/d

- **M&A:** Acquired Arumani to expand European modular construction and mechanical assemblies (Aug 2026); Core Pipe Products reported as acquired (Sep 2026, unconfirmed). [finanznachrichten.de · Signalbase]

No dated public information found for this period: Oventrop (4), Spirotech (4), ADEY (3), Cetetherm (3), ESBE (3), Fernox (3), Frese (3), Giacomini (3), HERZ Armaturen (3), PAW (3), PEWO Energietechnik (3), Wessels Company (3), Zilmet (3).

* Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar: Q1 = October–December, Q2 = January–March, Q3 = April–June, Q4 = July–September. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them (e.g. Q1 2026 = October–December 2025). * Siemens Smart Infrastructure: Siemens' fiscal year ends 30 September; quarters are shown as Siemens labels them (Q1 = October–December). For half-year reporters Q2 = H1; FY 2025 = full-year results. Organic growth as each company defines it (Belimo: local currencies; Emerson: underlying; Pentair: core).